

6 Influences of developments in religious belief	6.1	Views about life after death across a range of religious traditions a) Immortality of the soul: soul as non-physical and spiritual and continuing to exist after death of body. b) Rebirth: belief there is no unchanging soul and importance of karma. c) Reincarnation: transmigration of souls and importance of karma. d) Replica theory: notion that one can die in one body and continue to live in a different body while being the same person, including after death. e) Resurrection: belief that God will restore the dead in bodily form to eternal life. With reference to the ideas of J Hick.
	6.2	Points for discussion about life after death a) Relationship between mind and body, including variations of dualism and monism. b) Life after death linked to moral reasoning, near death experiences, debates related to role of evidence, religious language. With reference to the ideas of Plato and Aristotle.
	6.3	Religion and science debates and their significance for philosophy of religion a) Methodologies with emphasis on observation, hypothesis and experiment, identifying connections and differences vis a vis religious belief and processes; miracles. b) Creation themes and scientific cosmologies: Big Bang, steady state theories, intelligent design and irreducible complexity, creationism, cosmological constant, evolution, Gaia hypothesis. With reference to the ideas of C Darwin and R Dawkins.

List of extracts for Paper 1: Philosophy of Religion

Students are expected to study a range of texts that support and underpin their knowledge and understanding. The assessment will include two extended-response questions on an excerpt, sourced from this extracts list. The following texts are **not** exclusive to the topic areas under which they appear; students will need to be able to apply these texts across any suitable topic area. These are published in the *A Level Religious Studies Anthology: Paper 1 – Philosophy of Religion* which can be downloaded from our website.

(1) Mitchell B (ed) – *The Philosophy of Religion*, 1st edition, J Mackie – Chapter 5 Evil and Omnipotence, pp.92-104 (Oxford University Press, 1977) ISBN 9780198750185

(2) Mitchell B (ed) – *The Philosophy of Religion*, 1st edition, Flew A, Hare R M – Chapter 1 Theology and Falsification: A Symposium, pp. 13-18 (Oxford University Press, 1976) ISBN 9780198750185

(3) Mitchell B (ed) – *The Philosophy of Religion*, 1st edition, Flew A, Mitchell B – Chapter 1 Theology and Falsification: A Symposium, pp.18-22 (Oxford University Press, 1976) ISBN 9780198750185

(4) www.biblicalcatholic.com/apologetics/p20.htm (Russell B and Copleston F – The Existence of God)

Assessment information

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment is 2 hours.
- The assessment is out of 80 marks.
- The assessment consists of three sections.
- Students must answer all questions in Section A, Section B and Section C.
- The paper includes short-open, open-response and extended writing questions.
- See *Appendix 1* for the command words that will be used in the examination paper.
- Use of specialist language will be assessed as it is through the selection and deployment of specialist language and terminology that students are able to demonstrate their knowledge and understanding of religion and belief.

Synoptic assessment

Synoptic assessment requires students to work across different parts of a qualification and to show their accumulated knowledge and understanding of a topic or subject area.

Synoptic assessment enables students to show their ability to combine their skills, knowledge and understanding with breadth and depth of the subject.

Students will be able to demonstrate this through the extended essay in Question 4.

Sample assessment materials

A sample paper and mark scheme can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 3 Advanced GCE in Religious Studies Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* document.